to do what he can do best. In the past, the valiant came forward for defence, the studious for advanced knowledge and to teach: there was no superiority and inferiority in the system, merely capability. Varna Vyavastha was based on the view that a society is an organic whole; its purpose was to bring physical and spiritual happiness within everybody's reach.

Upadhyaya's philosophy did not stop there, but extended from Samashti to Parameshthi (society to God). Bharatiya culture, after all, does not end with humanity, but includes all naturally occurring things in creation—flora, fauna, air, water, sunlight, animals, rivers, planets. The Bharatiya Advaita philosophy begins at the family, encompassing humanity, the animal world, plant life, the inanimate world, and stops at nothing short of the Universe. Thus the philosophy of Integral Humanism envisages, in the words of an admirer, 'an ennobling expanse of human consciousness'.

Unlike Western social and political theories, Upadhyaya stressed, Integral Humanism did not emerge as a reaction to any particular circumstance and was based on 'positive' thinking. 'If by nature man is such that he does not mind fighting with others to enrich himself at the cost of others, then it is impossible to teach him to love others and live for them'.[54] But, in the Indian context of Bharatiya Advaita, it was clear that Integral Humanism was the only way forward. Upadhyaya advocated national reconstruction on the basis of this philosophy. However, the duty of Indians was not only to protect their culture, but to make it dynamic and efficient. 'If we march ahead,' Upadhyaya concluded, 'we will be able to place before the world ideals like nationalism, democracy, equality and world-amity in a balanced and integral form, along with permanent values in Bharatiya culture.'

When Deen Dayal Upadhyaya was expounding his political philosophy, he could not have foreseen the day that a political party claiming to be working in his name would govern with a crushing parliamentary majority. To what extent can they be said to have put his beliefs into practice?

The proliferation of Deen Dayal Upadhyaya institutions and schemes is misleading. The prophet of the BJP has so far been honoured in lip-